

SUBJECT PROPERTY | EXTERIOR STREETVIEW

VERDICT: DO NOT BUY (HOLD) / DO NOT BUY (FLIP) | INVESTMENT SCORE: 35/100

PROPERTY & VALUATION SNAPSHOT

Property Details	Data
Property Type	3-Unit Multi-Family
Beds	6
Baths	3
Year Built	1900

Valuation Metric	Estimated Value
Asking Price	$800,000
Recommended MAO	$720,000
Est. FMV	$737,200 - $782,800
Est. ARV	$1,350,000
Est. Renovation Budget	$320,000

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

114 Graham Street is a functionally obsolete 3-unit multi-family asset located in the highly desirable Heights neighborhood of Jersey City. The property requires a massive $320,000 Renovation Budget to cure severe deferred maintenance and antiquated MEP systems. In its As-Is state, the asset generates an As-Is Gross Rent of $68,400, resulting in a dangerous 0.75 DSCR and negative cash flow. While stabilizing the asset achieves a 1.29 DSCR and a positive Stabilized Cash Flow of $1,034 per month, the current asking price leaves virtually no margin for error, resulting in negative projected net profits for flippers. Success hinges entirely on aggressive acquisition price negotiation and flawless execution.

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FINANCIAL SYNTHESIS & STRATEGY COMPARISON

The financial viability of 114 Graham Street is severely constrained by its high acquisition cost relative to the required capital expenditures. In its As-Is state, the property generates a negative monthly cash flow of ($890), yielding a dismal (4.77%) Cash-on-Cash return and a dangerous 0.75 DSCR. The 4.06% As-Is Cap Rate is significantly lower than the 6.00% Interest Rate, resulting in severe negative leverage. The heavy $320,000 renovation budget is mandatory to modernize the antiquated centralized boiler system and achieve the maximum pro-forma rents. For a flipper, the base case scenario yields a net loss of ($1,982) due to exorbitant hard money interest and holding costs consuming the $230,000 in forced appreciation. For a buy-and-hold investor, stabilizing the asset pushes the DSCR to a safe 1.29 and the Cap Rate to 4.96%, but the initial capital outlay is immense.

STRATEGY A: BUY & HOLD (LONG-TERM)

UNDERWRITING ASSUMPTIONS

Underwriting Assumption	Value
Purchase Price	$800,000
Down Payment %	25.00%
Interest Rate	6.00%
Amortization Period	30 Years
Expense Ratio	50.00%

OPERATING PRO-FORMA

Line Item	Current (As-Is)	Stabilized
Gross Rent	$68,400	$117,000
Vacancy Loss	$3,420	$5,850
EGI	$64,980	$111,150
Operating Expenses	$32,490	$55,575
NOI	$32,490	$55,575
Debt Service	$43,168	$43,168
Monthly Cash Flow	($890)	$1,034

YIELD & RETURN METRICS

Metric	Current (As-Is)	Stabilized
Cap Rate	4.06%	4.96%
Cash-on-Cash Return	(4.77%)	2.28%
DSCR	0.75	1.29

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STRATEGY B: FIX & FLIP (SHORT-TERM)

HARD MONEY TERMS

Hard Money Loan Structure	Value
Loan Amount	$1,040,000
Total Points	$20,800
Total Interest (6 mos)	$57,200

CAPITAL REQUIREMENTS

Capital & Exit Costs	Value
Holding Costs	$11,482
Exit Costs	$108,000
Acquisition/Closing Costs	$32,000
Acquisition Fee	$2,500
Total Deal Cost	$1,351,982

PROJECTED RETURNS

Projected Flip Margin	Value
Projected ARV	$1,350,000
Net Profit	($1,982)
Cash-on-Cash Return	(0.64%)
Forced Appreciation	$230,000

FIX & FLIP SENSITIVITY MATRIX

Scenario	Purchase Price	Rehab Cost	ARV	Net Profit	CoC Return
Best Case	$760,000	$288,000	$1,485,000	$201,119	64.49%
Base Case	$800,000	$320,000	$1,350,000	($1,982)	(0.64%)
Worst Case	$840,000	$352,000	$1,215,000	($205,081)	(65.71%)

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RENOVATION & CAPEX ANALYSIS

The property is functionally obsolete and requires a comprehensive, down-to-the-studs gut rehabilitation. Visible defects include peeling masonry paint indicating moisture wicking, antiquated window AC units, and a centralized radiator heating system that must be replaced with separately metered HVAC units to shift utility costs to tenants. The 1900 vintage strongly suggests the presence of lead-based paint, asbestos, knob-and-tube wiring, and end-of-life galvanized plumbing. The listing notes a 'finished' basement ready for renovation, which requires rigorous verification of ceiling heights and egress compliance before factoring into gross living area. The exact plumbing layout for the 3 bathrooms across the 3 units requires verification, as the distribution is not explicitly detailed.

ITEMIZED CAPEX BUDGET

Category	Est. Cost	Priority
Architecture, Permitting & Soft Costs	$15,000	High
Demolition & Environmental Abatement	$25,000	High
Exterior (Roof, Siding, Windows, Masonry)	$55,000	Medium
Mechanicals (3x HVAC, Electrical Heavy-Up, Plumbing)	$85,000	Critical
Interior Finishes (3x Kitchens, 3x Baths, Flooring, Paint)	$125,000	High
Contingency Reserve	$15,000	Critical

ESTIMATED CONSTRUCTION TIMELINE

Phase	Description	Est. Duration
Phase 1	Architecture, Permitting & Approvals	6 Weeks
Phase 2	Demolition & Environmental Abatement	3 Weeks
Phase 3	Structural Repairs, Exterior Envelope & Roof	4 Weeks
Phase 4	Rough MEP (Mechanical, Electrical, Plumbing)	4 Weeks
Phase 5	Insulation, Drywall & Basement Waterproofing	4 Weeks
Phase 6	Interior Finishes (Kitchens, Baths, Flooring, Paint)	6 Weeks
Phase 7	Final Fixtures, Punch List & CO Inspections	3 Weeks

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MARKET & ZONING INTELLIGENCE

Located in the highly sought-after Jersey City Heights, the property benefits from exceptional transit connectivity, flanked by the 119 and 125 direct-to-NYC bus lines and situated a half-mile from the 9th Street Light Rail elevator. The neighborhood features a dense, grid-like urban layout promoting high walkability to the Central Avenue commercial corridor, offering a '15-minute city' lifestyle. While the broader Hudson County rental market is booming, the hyper-local 07307 rental market is currently 'COOL' with 374 available listings, demanding top-tier finishes to avoid vacancy. The area's moderate-to-low crime rate and proximity to green spaces like Riverview-Fisk Park heavily attract young professionals and families priced out of Hoboken and Downtown Jersey City.

ENVIRONMENTAL & LOCATIONAL FACTORS

Environmental Factor	Status / Impact
Nearest Transit	119/125 Bus Lines & 9th St Light Rail (High Impact)
Crime Rate Status	17.64 per 1,000 (Moderate/Low Impact)
Flood Zone	X (Minimal Hazard)
Wetlands	None Present
Contamination	Moderate/High Risk (Pre-1978 Lead/Asbestos)

UNIT MIX & PROJECTED RENT ROLL

Unit Type	Count	Current Avg Rent	Pro-Forma Rent
Unit 1 (Layout Unverified)	1	$1,900	$3,250
Unit 2 (Layout Unverified)	1	$1,900	$3,250
Unit 3 (Layout Unverified)	1	$1,900	$3,250

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TAX ASSESSMENT & APPEAL STRATEGY

The subject property is currently assessed at $383,900, which implies a market value of $527,190 based on the Director's Ratio of 72.82%. However, the True Market Value (FMV) is appraised at $760,000, resulting in a Subject Ratio of 50.51%. Because this ratio falls below the Lower Limit of 61.90%, the property is classified as Case C (Under-Assessed). Filing a tax appeal is highly discouraged, as it carries a severe risk of triggering a reassessment that would raise the annual tax burden. Under New Jersey law, spot assessments are illegal, so the current tax bill of $8,572 should remain flat unless a town-wide revaluation occurs or significant permitted renovations trigger a reassessment.

CHAPTER 123 TAX METRICS

Tax Assessment Metric	Value
Current Assessment	$383,900
Implied Market Value	$527,190
True Market Value	$760,000
Subject Ratio	50.51%
Director Ratio	72.82%
Lower Limit	61.90%
Est. Tax Savings	$0

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IDENTIFIED CRITICAL RISKS

- Acquisition Price Margin: The current asking price leaves zero margin for error, resulting in negative net profits for flippers and negative cash flow for As-Is buy-and-hold investors.

- Environmental Hazards: 1900 vintage carries a high probability of lead-based paint and asbestos, potentially inflating demolition costs.

- Utility Metering: Centralized radiator heating forces the landlord to bear winter utility costs, severely compressing operating margins if not separated.

- Basement Legality: The 'finished' basement may lack proper egress, ceiling height, or municipal permits, posing a liability and limiting usable square footage.

- Rental Market Saturation: A 'COOL' hyper-local rental market with 374 active listings increases the risk of extended vacancy if finishes are not top-tier.

MITIGATION STRATEGIES

- Aggressive Negotiation: Negotiate the purchase price down by at least 5-10% to create a viable profit margin and buffer against unforeseen CapEx.

- MEP Modernization: Completely remove the centralized boiler and install three separately metered HVAC systems to shift utility costs directly to tenants.

- Rigorous Due Diligence: Conduct comprehensive environmental testing and verify basement legality/egress compliance with the municipality before closing.

- Premium Finishes: Execute a high-end, NYC-commuter-grade renovation to stand out in the saturated rental market and justify top-of-market pro-forma rents.

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DUE DILIGENCE: VERIFICATION MATRIX

The following matrix highlights critical structural, zoning, or environmental discrepancies between municipal public records and the marketed property details.

Data Point	Public Record	Listing Claim	Risk Level
Unit Count	3 Units (Class 2 / 3U)	Triplex (3 Units)	LOW
Year Built	1900	Not Provided	LOW
Parking Availability	Not Specified	Lacks off-street parking	HIGH
Exterior Material	Frame (Wood)	Aluminum	MODERATE
Basement Status	Not Specified	Finished, ready for full renovation	MODERATE

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SALES COMPARABLES (RECENT CLOSINGS)

Address	Sale Price	SqFt	Beds	Baths	Sale Date
630 Palisade Ave	$1,475,000	N/A	6	3	03/27/2026
132 Griffith St	$1,100,000	N/A	6	3	02/17/2026
526A Liberty Ave	$1,160,000	N/A	6	3	11/14/2025
108 Terrace Ave	$1,375,000	N/A	6	4	11/14/2025
421 Liberty Ave	$1,402,000	N/A	6	5	03/30/2026
45 Graham St	$1,395,000	1600	5	3	12/30/2025

RENTAL MARKET TRENDS

Rental Trend Metric	Value
Median Rent	$2,600
Available Rentals	374
Market Temp	COOL
Yearly Change	$0

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